

The Internet of Things

Our traditional connection to the internet has undergone a radical change over the last couple of decades. We have progressed from simple terminals and desktop PCs to many different kinds of mobile devices such as laptops, tablets and of course, mobile phones. These devices however, are connected to us externally and are a sharp contrast to the wave of revolution that is the advent of wearable technology. We will soon be equipped with a network of wireless devices that possess the ability to communicate with no interference from us humans. And so, gadgets including head mounted displays and smartwatches are part of an array of technologies that will revamp the way in which we communicate and share among ourselves and the internet itself, ushering in The Internet of Things (IoT) becoming a necessity rather than a luxury.

We can already track our exercise, monitor our heart rates and even keep a track of the quality of our sleep. The wearables in question include Fitbit, Jawbone Up and the Nike Fuelband. These capabilities will grow in the next few years, so much so that we can imagine a future in which we'll be able to swallow a pill that can monitor our digestive function and send intelligent and relevant information to doctors as the need arises and in the context of what we're doing at that point of time. Another example of the uses of IoT would be a future in which expectant mothers will go around wearing "smart tattoos" that lets them monitor the health and activity of the baby(ies) growing inside them and which are capable of alerting the doctor early about the onset of labor.

As these wonderful devices get integrated into the large net that is The Internet of Things, sharing of huge quantities of data generated by our bodies, data related to the well being of physical and even mental state, our mood, personal preferences and so on and so forth will become extremely commonplace with health providers, retailers and businesses.

The question that now comes to mind is, how much longer do we have to wait till we have this kind of connectivity in our homes? Imagine coming home to your heart rate monitor unlocking the front door. Walk into your living space to find a cool glass of water and the air conditioner already running at the optimum temperature, thanks to your smartband finding that you were slightly dehydrated with a little higher body temperature than is optimum. Even in retail, wearables and connectivity can be used for real time data crunching to provide the best service while maximizing profits.

For example, Yelp provides a service which allows users to point their